



SOLDERING AND HOT GLUE

That white smoke is FLUX, not lead.

Lead boils at about 1,740 °C; the iron runs near 350 °C. What you can smell is rosin flux, and it causes occupational asthma. Watery eyes, a scratchy throat or a cough means you have had enough of it — say so.

Lead gets in by being swallowed

Hands, bench, phone, snack, mouth. That is the route. No food or drink at the bench, wash your hands and arms properly afterwards, and wipe the surface down.

The iron lives in its stand. Every time.

Hot glue burns worse than the iron

It is cooler, and it sticks — so it keeps putting heat into you and you cannot pull away. Cold running water for 15 minutes, and do not peel the glue off first.

- Safety glasses. Solder spits when flux flashes.
- Use the fume extractor at the source — a desk fan just moves it onto the person next to you.
- The joint, the component leads and the board stay hot after the iron has gone.